

Αὐτόλυκος ὁ Πιτανναῖος

Autolycus of Pitane on the Moving Sphere and Rising Stars

eul_aid: liq

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Ἀττική [Attic](#)

Domain: Ἐπιστήμη [Science](#)

Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)

Autolycus of Pitane was a Greek astronomer and mathematician active in the late 4th century BCE, making him a contemporary of Euclid. He is among the earliest Greek mathematical astronomers whose complete works survive. His writings reflect a stage of astronomy prior to the advanced spherical developments of later Hellenistic scholars.

His two extant treatises are **On the Moving Sphere**, the oldest surviving Greek mathematical treatise, and **On Risings and Settings**.

Autolycus holds major significance as the author of the earliest complete Greek mathematical texts. His works are foundational in spherical astronomy, systematically detailing the geometry of the celestial sphere and stellar phenomena through a deductive approach. They served as standard textbooks, forming part of the "Little Astronomy" curriculum, and were studied by later figures like Pappus of Alexandria, providing crucial insight into pre-Hellenistic astronomical theory.

Works (2)

- [Περὶ Ἀνατολῶν καὶ Δύσεων](#) · [On Risings and Settings](#) · 38 passages
- [Περὶ τῆς κινούμενης σφαίρας](#) · [On the Moving Sphere](#) · 16 passages